

of rules that can be applied, but suffice it to say that as you'll discover, rules can be used to auto-move messages when they arrive, auto-delete messages, check for messages with a certain word in the subject line and auto-forward it, etc.

Tools > Accounts > Mail is where you'll be going to add a new mail account; the Wizard guides you through the steps, but you need to know all the details, of course.

And finally, for the all-important Store Folder: OE stores your mails in an obscure location. Since you should be taking regular backups, it would help if you changed it to someplace you know.



Change the Store Folder in OE and keep backing that folder up

Go to Tools > Options > Maintenance > Store Folder, and the location will be displayed (as in the middle window below). Click Change, and you'll be asked to browse to a nice folder where your messages will be stored, as in the right-most window below.

That's all, folks! There really isn't too much more to OE—all we can say is, look in Tools > Options, and you'll find several tabs, all of which contain rather self-explanatory items. Set them according to what you want, for example, what your HTML mails should look like.

6.5 Windows Live Mail (XP and Vista)

It's pretty, very pretty. It's like Outlook Express, but it's pretty. It can search the full text of e-mails for a keyword you specify in a convenient box on the main window, but for that, you need to download Windows Desktop Search (by clicking on the link right there). Windows Live Mail is, essentially, a good-looking replacement for OE on XP and for Windows Mail on Vista.